

Technical / Product Spec

Overview

Problem Statement: The first phase of the new client support service needs to keep new clients active after they create their first task, so they do not disappear after setup begins.

Product Goal: Build a support service that watches for task creation, waits 15 minutes of inactivity, and then sends the right onboarding nudge based on whether the client can assign the task, create another task, or needs to add an employee first.

Recommended Shape: Use one support orchestrator with task-activation tracking, employee-aware branching, a 15-minute reminder scheduler, and a human escalation path.

Implementation Notes: Keep this phase narrow: onboarding retention around the first task, one automatic 15-minute nudge, no general client support, and no unrelated workflow expansion yet.

Goals

- Recognize first-time activation events and separate them from general support.
- Detect when a client has created a task but has gone inactive for the 15-minute onboarding window.
- Check whether the client has employees available for task assignment.
- Send the correct onboarding nudge based on client state.
- Track case state from first task created to active user so the team can see who is still at risk of dropping off.
- Escalate ambiguous or blocked cases to a human with enough context to act fast.
- Measure activation drop-off, employee setup completion, and the time it takes to get a client past the first-task stage.

Architecture

- An existing messaging or event surface receives the first task creation event and forwards it to a support orchestrator.
- An activation tracker starts a 15-minute onboarding window when the client creates their first task or returns to an unfinished activation state.
- A client state store keeps employee count, task assignment status, onboarding stage, and reminder state for every client.
- A nudge resolver checks the current state and chooses the right message template.

- A reminder scheduler sends one automatic follow-up after the inactivity window expires.
- A human escalation path creates a handoff task when the resolver cannot confidently choose the next action.
- A logging layer stores inbound events, outbound nudges, state changes, and resolution notes for audit and review.
- A lightweight metrics layer counts activation drop-off, employee setup completion, nudges sent, and first-task success rate.

Data model

- cases: case_id, client_id, status, onboarding_stage, last_task_created_at, last_client_action_at, employee_count, unassigned_task_count, reminder_due_at, reminder_sent_at, last_nudge_type, escalation_reason, resolution_summary.
- tasks: task_id, client_id, status, assignee_id, created_at, updated_at, source_channel, external_task_id.
- employees: employee_id, client_id, status, created_at, updated_at.
- nudges: nudge_id, case_id, trigger_type, template_version, due_at, sent_at, status, message_body.
- events: event_id, client_id, event_type, payload, created_at, source_channel.

Automation

- On first task creation, open an activation case and start the 15-minute onboarding timer.
- If the client becomes active again before the timer expires, reset or cancel the pending nudge.
- When the timer expires and the client has employees available, send a message that says they can assign the current task or create another task.
- When the timer expires and the client has no employees, send a message that says the first step is to add an employee.
- If the task is already assigned and the client is active, do not send the onboarding nudge.
- If the client is blocked or the state is unclear, create a human escalation task with a summary of the relevant task and employee context.

Workflows

1. First-task activation flow: a client creates their first task, the service opens an activation case, and a 15-minute inactivity timer starts.

2. Employee-aware follow-up flow: the timer expires, the service checks whether employees exist, and it sends either the assign-task prompt or the add-employee prompt.
3. Return-to-active flow: the client assigns the task, creates another task, or adds an employee before the timer fires, and the onboarding nudge is canceled.
4. Escalation flow: if the task state is inconsistent or the client is blocked, the service creates a human handoff with the task context, employee count, and next recommended action.
5. Ongoing activation flow: once the client has assigned the task or added an employee, the case is updated to reflect that onboarding is progressing.

Implementation plan

1. Define the activation-state taxonomy and decide what counts as a first-task onboarding case in v1.
2. Collect the onboarding message templates for the assign-task and add-employee branches.
3. Implement the event intake that opens or updates an activation case on first task creation.
4. Build the client state store and transitions for active, waiting, nudged, escalated, and resolved.
5. Implement the 15-minute scheduler and the branch logic that checks employee availability before sending a nudge.
6. Add the escalation handoff summary and human task creation path.
7. Add logging and metrics so the team can see activation drop-off, reminders sent, and first-task success.
8. Test the flow with sample activation states and refine the message templates before expanding the scope.

Non-goals

- Do not support general client support categories in v1.
- Do not build a full CRM or task management system.
- Do not auto-send messages beyond the onboarding nudge defined in this phase.
- Do not replace a CRM or full ticketing system.
- Do not handle billing, renewals, or product feature requests in this phase.
- Do not build a public self-serve help center yet.

Acceptance criteria

- A client's first task opens or updates an activation case within the support flow.

- After 15 minutes of inactivity, the service sends the correct nudge based on whether the client has employees.
- If the client has no employees, the message tells them to add an employee first.
- If the client has employees, the message tells them they can assign the current task or create another task.
- If the client returns to active use before the timer expires, the nudge is canceled or suppressed.
- Non-onboarding requests are not routed into this service by default.

Risks

- If the 15-minute window is too aggressive, the reminder can feel noisy instead of helpful.
- Missing or stale employee data can cause the wrong onboarding nudge to be sent.
- If task assignment events are delayed, the system may send a nudge after the client has already progressed.
- A weak handoff summary can slow down human escalation and make the client wait longer.
- If activation success is not measured clearly, the team may not know whether the onboarding flow is actually keeping clients engaged.

Open questions

- Which support channel is in scope for v1: WhatsApp only, or also email or portal intake?
- Should the 15-minute timer start from first task creation, last task update, or the client's last meaningful action?
- Is the onboarding nudge a one-time message, or should it repeat if the client stays inactive?
- Who owns escalations once the case is handed off to a human?
- Should the service support more than one language in the first phase?

Future ideas

- Add a visible onboarding progress tracker so the team can see the client's activation stage at a glance.
- Add a second follow-up nudge if the client still does not respond after the first reminder.
- Expand the same support service to billing, renewals, and general account help after activation is stable.
- Add multilingual nudge templates for clients who prefer Hebrew or English.

- Add analytics that show whether adding an employee or assigning the first task has the biggest impact on retention.